

MARKETING GOALS

1M

Waitlist Users (Global)
Growth owns · Mktg contributes 20%+

500K

SME Pipeline (within 2mo of waitlist)
CFO Summit + Offline (Isham) + Direct Network

1M

Social Followers
Benchmark Revolut · Beat WIO · LI-first

20%+

Mktg Contribution to Growth
Every \$ ties to a measurable metric

CBUAE

License (Expected Sep 2026)
AAS = regulator POC · Contingency Nov 1

18

Markets at Wave 1
USD/ACH global · AED = UAE only

POSITIONING — HOW WE TALK ABOUT MAL (PRIORITY ORDER)

P0 — LEAD WITH THIS

Licensed Financial Institution

"Clearly a bank — a full bank with a license"
Not a wrapper, not a prepaid card, not an EMI. Always the first thing we say.

P1 — DIFFERENTIATOR

AI-Native Banking

"Open an account in 30 seconds"
AI is not a feature. The entire bank is built on it.

P2 — CHERRY ON TOP

Islamic & Shariah-Compliant

"Ethical banking as the added value layer"
Built in, not bolted on. Earns trust without narrowing the audience.

Global vs UAE: Mal (global) ≠ Mal Bank (UAE/CBUAE). AAS = POC for Public Affairs.

Moat: "Only moat is user-base; everything else is replicable." Must be quantitative.

Messaging: No generic claims. Only flex real experiences. Be quantitative or stay quiet.

UNIFIED ROADMAP — PRODUCT LAUNCHES, MARKETING PHASES, LICENSING & EVENTS

JUN 2026 — PHASE 1

Plumbing

Internal QA, stress testing, end-to-end flows. No external comms.

SEP 2026

CBUAE License

Expected. If delayed → launch moves to Nov 1 or event to Nov 11.

OCT 10, 2026

Grand Launch

Contingency: Nov 11 if license delayed past Sep 1.

TBD — WITHIN FIRST YEAR

CFO Summit (50 pax)

Private round table · Top CFOs in ME

Phase 2: Waitlist Hype (Pre-Launch)

5 Hype Wins: UI excellence · Authentically Islamic · Product speed & suite · Referral + Founder Card + beta · Private community, 20-30 influencers (LI primary, explore IG/X). Isham + agency.

Phase 3: ACH Launch Comms

"You have Mal — never need SWIFT again" · EG, TR, IN, PK · Convenience is the message

USD Account
Retail

USD Card
Retail

SME USD Account
SME

SME USD Card
SME

Jun 2026
INTERNAL

USD Payout
Retail

PFM Agent
Retail

SME USD Payout
SME

Jun 2026

Jul 2026
LAUNCH

Invoice Factoring
SME

Aug 2026

AED Account
Retail

AED Card
Retail

Personal Financing
Retail

Sep 2026

SME AED Account
SME

Oct 2026

AED Payout
Retail

Auto Financing
Retail

SME Financing
SME

SME AED Payout
SME

SME AED Card
SME

Sep 2026

IVF Financing
Retail

Nov 2026

Credit Card
Retail

Tuition Financing
Retail

Dec 2026

Travel Agent
Retail

Tax Agent
SME

Accounting Agent
SME

2027
SCALE

Shopping Agent
Retail

CFO Agent
SME

WAVE 1 (Jul '26): 8 products - 18 mkts

WAVE 2 (Oct '26): 10 products - UAE

WAVE 3 (Nov–Dec '26): 3 products - UAE

WAVE 4 (2027): 5 AI Agents

OWNERSHIP MATRIX

BUDGET ALLOCATION

GROWTH — 80%

BRAND & MKTG — 20%

Budget: Amine · Growth strategy: Mukund · Hiring: Sama

DOMAIN	OWNER	SCOPE
Growth	Mukund	Userbase, retention, referral, acquisition (80%)
Marketing	Manar, Yasmeen, Isham	Brand, PR, influencers, events, social, TOV, content
Sales / SME	SME Team + Isham	Offline onboarding, CFO Summit, distribution
Product	David, VK, Manar	Demos, tech comms, launches
Public Affairs	AAS	CBUAE comms (UAE-only)
Compliance	Maen + Walid	Risk, regulatory readiness
Hiring	Sama	Marketing team hiring plan
Budgets	Amine	Budget allocation & approval

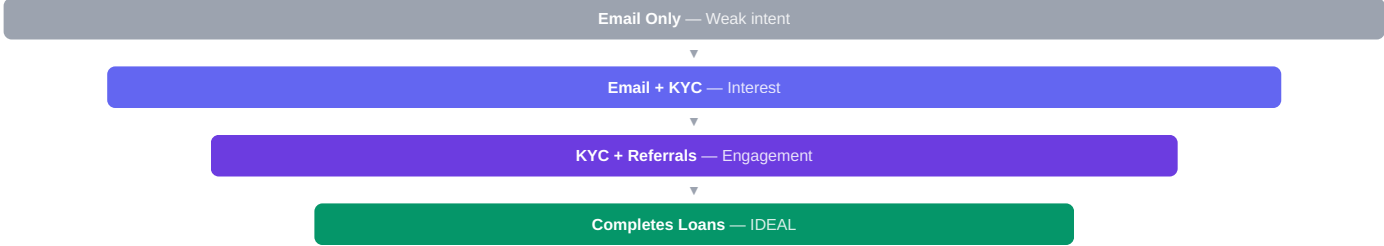
Rule: Mktg does NOT own growth metrics but must contribute 20%+. Referral program owned by Growth.

INCENTIVE STRATEGY BY SEGMENT

SEGMENT	HOOK	INCENTIVE	PRODUCT ANGLE	CHANNEL
Window Shoppers	"Join waitlist, get paid"	Cash for signup; share LI/IG/X → \$X	Waitlist virality	Social, Paid LI
Adopters	"Try the tech first"	Founder Card + 1-yr sub + beta + community	UI, speed, process	LI Thought Leaders
Retail	"Never need SWIFT again"	Global Accounts first (USD/ACH); 4x salary	Expats EG/TR/IN/PK; lending later (Wave 2–3)	Partnerships, Digital
SMEs	"Upload paperwork — eligible in seconds"	AED 300K at 5%; Mal pays your bills	Bank + Lender one-stop	CFO Summit, Offline

Competitive Stack: FAB = large SMEs, no lending. WIO = tiny SMEs. EFG = lender not bank. Mal = Bank + Lender. One-stop.

WAITLIST FUNNEL & GUARDRAILS



GUARDRAIL	RATIONALE
Clients ≠ Partners	Closes doors (ADNOC = client)
No generic claims	Be quantitative or stay quiet
Mal ≠ Mal Bank	CBUAE only cares about UAE
Only real experiences	"2 seconds" not "we're fast"
90% revenue = lending	Banking acquires, lending generates

BRAND DNA (TO DEFINE)

- Foundation**
- TOV · Brand Architecture · Targets (not personas) · Assets (decks, attire, gifting) · Internal AI for corporate comms
- Owned Media**
- LI (primary), IG, X · Events · PR · McKinsey papers · Private community (beta)

WAITLIST HYPE PLAYBOOK

- 10-20 influencers (LI primary, explore IG/X/other platforms)
- Isham identifies influencers & groups per platform with 3rd-party agency
- "UI is great, credit limit in 30 seconds"
- CTA: "I just joined the Mal waitlist and I have 5 slots to give"
- Share to LI/IG/X → get \$X free (package TBD)
- Benchmarks: Revolut, Clubhouse waitlist models

5 Hype Pillars

- UI excellence
- Authentically Islamic
- Product speed
- Referral + Founder Card
- Private community

CFO SUMMIT & LAUNCH EVENT

- CFO Summit**
- Top CFOs in ME, 50 max, private round table
 - 2-3 VIP speakers (e.g., Hazem)
 - "Where are you facing issues with your existing bank?"
 - Capture: company info, employees, distribution
 - "Mal pays your bills — onboard your vendors"
- Media Training**

Amine David VK Zigor Maen+Walid Youssef

2nd line: Talga, Rideu, Izz

IMMEDIATE ACTION ITEMS

#	OWNER(S)	ACTION	PRIORITY	STATUS
1	AAS + Walid	Roadmap + product suite sign-off, share with team	URGENT	FINAL STAGES
2	Manar + Yasmeen + Isham	Brainstorm marketing strategy, roles & incentive strategy	URGENT	PENDING
3	Manar + Yasmeen + Isham	Brainstorm CFO Summit + Launch Event (Oct 10 / contingency Nov 11)	URGENT	PENDING
4	Manar	Budget allocations: marketing, brand, sales, growth (Amine approves)	HIGH	PENDING
5	Yasmeen + Walid	Schedule calls between Manar and GA team vs other product leads	HIGH	IN PROGRESS
6	Isham (lead) + Yasmeen (content)	Define waitlist referral package (share to LI/IG/X → \$X reward)	HIGH	PENDING
7	Isham + 3rd-party agency	Identify 10-20 influencers & groups per platform for paid hype	HIGH	PENDING
8	Marketing Team	Get to 1M waitlist users (incentive + ACH/USD — excl. sanctioned markets)	HIGH	PENDING
9	Marketing Team	Internal corporate comms + assets (brand DNA, gifting, decks, attire)	MEDIUM	PENDING
10	Mukund	Growth budget request strategy (Amine = budget holder)	MEDIUM	PENDING
11	Walid	Draft and document marketing roadmap, then meet to align	MEDIUM	PENDING
12	Sama / Amine	Hiring plan for marketing team (Sama = hiring, Amine = budget)	MEDIUM	PENDING

CRITICAL PATH
Plumbing (Jun) → Waitlist Hype → Wave 1 USD (Jul) → Invoice Factoring (Aug) → License (Sep) → Launch Event + Wave 2 (Oct) → Wave 3 (Nov–Dec) → AI Agents (2027)

25 products · 4 waves · 18 markets
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